

How To Write Email Subject Lines For Business



Most businesses use emails to communicate with both the clients and employees. Using emails to communicate comes with a number of advantages, but also with some challenges. Using email as a means of communication is quite effective. Emails are also a good marketing tool if used correctly. Many businesses fail to use this particular opportunity because of not knowing how to do it right. Writing an email should not be a challenge for you.

It is not that much of a difficult task, it is all about using the appropriate words for a specific email and how you present the email. In particular, lots of people fail because of their email subject line.

The subject line often plays a role in whether your recipient will open their email. A simple, concise, and short subject line should be enough. The majority of us fail because we do not pay as much attention to the subject line. No matter how good your email content is, the subject line needs to get the attention of the recipient.

Here are a couple of things to put into consideration when identifying your subject line.

What Is Your Email About?

The subject line should be relevant to the contents of your email. The subject line is more like a "title". Remember that every title is a summary of what your work is all about. Subject lines are similar, they give a reader an idea of what to expect. Therefore, it is recommended that you first summarize your email with a few words before proceeding to find the perfect subject line.





Be Selective



Be selective in your choice of words fit to use in the subject line. Do not use every word that comes to your mind. This is a process that involves identifying the perfect words to get attention and at the same time, communicate the right message. It is more or less playing around with words to give your email that level of importance to make your readers open the email. If you are sending an important or urgent email, be sure to include the words "important" and "urgent" in your subject line. This way your readers will be aware of the level of urgency.

Note: Please do not use words such as "urgent" and "important" if an email does not carry so much importance. Your future emails will be outrightly ignored, deleted, or considered to be spam.

Keep It Short, Clear, and Concise

One of the main attributes of business writing is keeping it short, clear, and concise. This is because all that is required of you are facts. The same is applicable to the subject lines. Have a short subject line that does not require your readers to open the email to read a complete sentence. Most email subject lines work with around 5 to 8 words or approximately 60 characters.

You should also avoid being ambiguous. Let your readers clearly understand what you are saying. Precision is key when writing business emails and having short subject lines will ensure that you follow this guideline. Make sure that you have the facts right. The subject line should contain accurate information.

Because of the nature of business practices, having a short subject line acts as your introduction. A long subject may precondition readers to dislike it, especially if it is a general business email. Short, clear, and precise subjects will have a better impact than a long rambling sentence.

Avoid Using Filler Words

Certain words should not be used in your subject line unless there are special circumstances. These words are often referred to as filler words. They are a waste of the subject line space. Filler words are often suitable for use in the main body of the email. Good examples include phrases such as “thank you”, “nice to meet you” or salutations (good morning, hello, etc.) among others. There is nothing wrong with using these words as long as you use them appropriately and in the right context. Just try to maintain the formality of business emails.

Filler words will make your subject line longer, forcing the reader to open the email in order to read the rest of it. Poorly structured subjects containing filler words will not perform the function of an effective subject. They will make the audience think your email is a social email and the business sense of your email gets lost.

Basic Email Etiquette

Let us say you are writing your email to an individual following a referral to them. Well, this person does not really know who you are and there is a chance they will regard your email as spam. How can you avoid being in such a situation?

Email etiquette dictates that you include the name of the person who referred you in the subject line. This is an example of how your subject line will look:

“Referral by John Smith for the position of Sales Representative “

Have a Timeframe



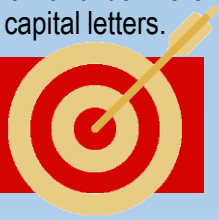
Construct your subject lines to have a timeline. Timelines create a sense of urgency and prompt your readers to open your email. Also, make a point of letting your readers know if you expect a response from them. Before the reader opens the email, the subject should communicate the urgency of them opening it.

Don’t Use UPPER CASE

Avoid the use of uppercase in writing your email and generally in any communication on any online platform. Use of capital letters will get attention but at a cost. Using uppercase tends to attract the wrong kind of attention from your readers. This is because, on most online platforms, capital letters are associated with shouting.

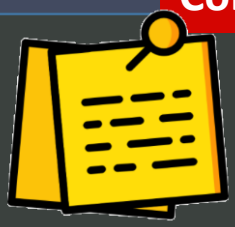
Your intention is not to make your readers anxious but instead, you want to warm them up to your email. You want them to enjoy reading your email and be more receptive. Therefore, avoid the use of capital letters.

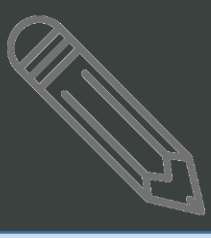
Avoid Misleading or Untruthful Subjects



Your email subject line is like a promise. When your audience reads it, a promise is made on what the email will contain. You should be sure not to have a subject that implies something different from what the email contains. You should not try to make them open your emails by promising attractive falsehoods in your subjects. This will work against you by irritating your audience.

Conclusion





Revolution in technology has changed the business world for the better. In the past, we had post offices for sending letters, which was a time-consuming process as it took days to have them delivered. But today all that has changed. With a click of a button, your message is sent and delivered almost instantly. Additionally, you have a variety of online platforms to choose from. Business writing is important for modern businesses and many of them have been able to tap into this opportunity to their advantage. Thanks to email, you can communicate with your clients all around the world. You could be in the USA but get to communicate with your clients in China. However, not all businesses have been able to tap into this amazing chance. This is because there is a particular way of structuring your email to get your reader’s attention. How well you communicate dictates how well you can maintain your business relationships. In particular, subject lines. Ensure that your subject lines conform to the proposed suggestions.

[1] http://teensmeanbusiness.com/write-email-subject-lines-business/